The results announced later in November showed a 77 percent victory for the ruling USDP. The pre-election playing field was titled heavily in favor of the USDP. Few problems were encountered during the process partially because of the decision of Aung San Suu Kyi's National League for Democracy (NLD) to boycott the process. Even with the overwhelming advantages, the USDP still engaged in massive manipulation of the vote count. The main tool used to control the process was “advance votes.” These were ballots that had been distributed early to anyone unable to vote on the allotted day. A huge majority of nearly 80 percent of all legislative seats went to the USDP-backed candidates. Other forms of manipulation and voting irregularities occurred throughout the process.

Once in place, the new regime abolished the SPDC. The military control was guaranteed through the huge majority in parliament as well as the constitutional provisions mentioned earlier. General Thein Sein and 22 of his cabinet ministers switched from military positions to civilian roles shortly before the election of 2010.

With a new system secured, the regime decided to release Aung San Suu Kyi from house arrest on November 13. Two factors may have played into the timing. First, the regime may have felt that Aung San Suu Kyi was a spent force whose time had passed. Second, by releasing her, the regime could put forward a new public face of accommodation, which coincided with the new “civilian” regime.

With her newfound freedom, Aung San Suu Kyi began meetings with NLD leaders to analyze options for the upcoming elections. After several months of internal debate, the NLD decided in late March to boycott the first scheduled elections in 20 years. Because of recent electoral legal changes, the party would be dissolved. This created a rift within the party because if the NLD were to participate in the new process, it would not only abandon its core principles, but also potentially harm its legitimacy. Furthermore the assumption would be that the 1990 victory was invalidated. The party may have also been sending a sign to armed ethnic groups in the northern reaches of the country that the election was illegitimate. The junta was demanding that the ethnic groups disarm.

The actual transfer of power to the new regime took place on March 30, 2011. General Than Shwe retired and was replaced by longtime junta